In 1876, Wallace proposed six separate zoogeographic regions: Nearctic (North America); Neotropics (South America); Palearctic (Europe, Africa north of the Sahara Desert, and Central, North, and East Asia); Afrotropics (Africa south of the Sahara Desert); Indomalaya (South and Southeast Asia); and Australasia (Australia, New Guinea, and New Zealand). Today Wallace's regions, with the addition of Oceania (the islands of the Pacific Ocean) and Antarctica, are known as biogeographic realms.



All of Siberia is in the Palearctic region, and the Siberian white birch trees depicted here are part of a subdivision called the East Siberian taiga.